PRACTITIONER REFERENCE

PMU Contraindication Chart

A quick screen, not a diagnosis. When in doubt, don't treat and ask for written medical clearance.

KEY **No** Don't treat **Wait [time]** Postpone Clear Physician clearance *Caution* Modify OK Fine after screening

IF CLIENT HAS	Brows (blade)	Brows (machine)	Lips	Eyeliner	Saline removal	SMP
HEALTH & CONDITIONS						
Pregnant or breastfeeding [1]	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**
Cold sore, active [2]	*Caution*	*Caution*	**No**	*Caution*	*Caution*	OK
Cold sore history [3]	OK	OK	*Caution*	OK	*Caution*	OK
Keloids, personal history	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**
Diabetes [4]	Clear	Clear	Clear	Clear	Clear	Clear
Autoimmune or immune drugs [5]	Clear	Clear	Clear	Clear	Clear	Clear
Chemo or radiation [6]	**Wait 6 mo**	**Wait 6 mo**	**Wait 6 mo**	**Wait 6 mo**	**Wait 6 mo**	**Wait 6 mo**
Eye surgery, glaucoma [7]	OK	OK	OK	Clear	*Caution*	OK
Skin condition in the area [8]	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**
Allergy: pigment, numbing [9]	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*
MEDICATIONS & SUPPLEMENTS						
Isotretinoin (Accutane) [10]	**Wait 12 mo**	**Wait 6 mo**	**Wait 6 mo**	**Wait 6 mo**	**Wait 6 mo**	**Wait 6 mo**
Topical retinoids near area [11]	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**
Blood thinners (Rx) [12]	Clear	Clear	Clear	Clear	Clear	Clear
Aspirin, fish oil, vitamin E [13]	**Wait 7 days**	**Wait 7 days**	**Wait 7 days**	**Wait 7 days**	**Wait 7 days**	**Wait 7 days**
Lash or brow growth serum [14]	*Caution*	*Caution*	OK	**Wait 3 mo**	*Caution*	OK
RECENT TREATMENTS & SKIN STATE						
Botox or filler, recent [15]	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 4 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	OK
Peel, laser, microneedling [16]	**Wait 4 wk**	**Wait 4 wk**	**Wait 4 wk**	**Wait 4 wk**	**Wait 4 wk**	**Wait 4 wk**
Sunburn, tan, self-tanner	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**

[1] Entire pregnancy and breastfeeding period.
[2] Lips: 2 weeks after fully healed. Elsewhere, if near area.
[3] Client asks physician about prevention. No drug advice.
[4] Controlled: physician clearance. Uncontrolled: defer.
[5] Defer during a flare; otherwise physician clearance.
[6] 6+ months after treatment ends, plus clearance.
[7] Ophthalmologist clearance; 6+ months after eye surgery.
[8] Infection, wound, rash, acne, psoriasis or eczema flare.
[9] Patch test; record. Use a tolerated anesthetic or none.
[10] Blade: 12 months off. Machine work: 6 months off.
[11] Stop 14 days before; off the healing area 4 weeks.
[12] Client never stops without prescriber OK. More bleeding.
[13] Only if not prescribed. Same for ginkgo and niacin.
[14] Prostaglandin: 3 mo before liner, or brows if used there.
[15] Botox 2+ weeks before. Lip filler 4+ weeks before lips.
[16] Near the area. After PMU: 4 wk post-heal; tell laser techs.

Conservative defaults; check your state rules. Sources disagree on many windows, so this chart uses the more cautious one. Your state or county body art rules, the pigment maker's instructions and the client's physician always come first. Review it yearly.